

MECH191 — Metallurgy

Course Introduction

Welcome & Syllabus Overview

Fall 2026 · Mondays, 5:00 – 7:30 PM · Kai Santos

Welcome to MECH 191

Course Description

A comprehensive introduction to the principles of metallurgy and material science, focusing on the structure, properties, and performance of metals and alloys. Topics include mechanical testing, metallography, phase diagrams, heat treatment, mechanical properties, corrosion, and failure analysis.

You'll gain hands-on experience in material testing, alloy composition, and microstructural analysis, and learn how to select and apply materials for real industrial purposes.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the relationship between structure, properties, and performance of metals and alloys
- Describe the phases in a metal alloy system using a phase diagram
- Apply heat treatment processes to modify metal properties for engineering applications
- Conduct lab tests to measure hardness, tensile strength, and ductility
- Interpret failure mechanisms — corrosion and fatigue — from properties and usage conditions
- Assess metal/alloy suitability for engineering scenarios: performance, durability, cost

Course Logistics

Credits & Prerequisites

3 credits · No prerequisites

Dates

August 24 – December 16, 2026
(17-week semester)

Meeting Time

Mondays, 5:00 PM – 7:30 PM

Classroom

PS101B

Office Hours

By appointment only

Instructor

Kainani “Kai” Santos
kainanis@hawaii.edu

Grading Scheme

Assignment	Count	Value Each	Total Points
Attendance	15	1	15
Alloy Research Portfolio	1	50	50
Unit Quizzes	5	5	25
Final Exam	1	10	10
Total			100

Final Exam

PS101B · December 16, 2026
5:00 – 7:00 PM

Must be returned by 7:00 PM or the score is automatically zero.

Final letter grades follow the standard A–F scale.

The Alloy Research Portfolio (50 pts) is graded internally across all 15 weekly modules plus a holistic end-of-semester review — see the Alloy Research Portfolio slide for details.

Course Roadmap — Five Units

Unit 1

Weeks 1–2

Foundations: What Metals Are and How They're Built

Unit 2

Weeks 4–6

Metal Families: Knowing What You're Working With

Unit 3

Weeks 7–9

Testing, Inspection & Quality: The Technician's Core Skills

Unit 4

Weeks 10–13

Manufacturing Processes: How Parts Are Made and What to Check

Unit 5

Weeks 14–16

Keeping Metal in Service: Welding, Failure, Corrosion & Modern Tech

Course Timeline

Wk	Date	Topic
1	Aug 24	Syllabus, PPE / Unit 1 begins
2	Aug 31	Unit 1 (cont.) — Unit 1 Quiz
3	Sep 7	<i>NO CLASS</i>
4	Sep 14	Unit 2 begins
5	Sep 21	Unit 2 (cont.)
6	Sep 28	Unit 2 (cont.) — Unit 2 Quiz
7	Oct 5	Unit 3 begins
8	Oct 12	Unit 3 (cont.)
9	Oct 19	Unit 3 (cont.) — Unit 3 Quiz

Wk	Date	Topic
10	Oct 26	Unit 4 begins
11	Nov 2	Unit 4 (cont.)
12	Nov 9	Unit 4 (cont.)
13	Nov 16	Unit 4 (cont.) — Unit 4 Quiz
14	Nov 23	Unit 5 begins
15	Nov 30	Unit 5 (cont.)
16	Dec 7	Unit 5 (cont.) — Unit 5 Quiz
17	Dec 16	<i>FINAL EXAM</i>

Tentative schedule — subject to change. Updates will be announced by the instructor.

The Alloy Research Portfolio

Every instructional week, you'll research one or more alloys from the class specimen set using real, published composition, properties, and applications data — no microscope work or lab session is required to complete it. Record your sources as you go.

Research

Look up the assigned alloy(s) using credible published sources.

Document

Record composition, properties, processing, and applications data with a proper source citation.

Submit

Answer that week's short-answer and critical-thinking questions. All 15 modules compile into one portfolio, due at the end of the semester.

Course Policies

Generative AI Policy

No form of generative AI (ChatGPT, Claude, Microsoft Copilot, Apple Intelligence, etc.) may be used, in whole or in part, to generate course materials or assignments. Grammar/spell-check tools (e.g., Grammarly, Word, Google Docs) are permitted to refine your own writing.

Academic Integrity

Cheating and plagiarism violate the Student Conduct Code and can result in expulsion. See the Leeward CC academic dishonesty policy for full definitions.

Participation Verification

Students who don't participate in Week 1 are marked "No Show" and administratively disenrolled with a full refund.

Title IX

Leeward CC prohibits sex- and gender-based discrimination. Contact the Title IX Coordinator at leetix@hawaii.edu for resources and support.

Technology & Materials

Textbooks (Provided Digitally)

Metallurgy, 5th ed.

B.J. Moniz

**Manufacturing Processes for Engineering Materials,
6th ed.**

S. Kalpakjian

All content is provided as PDFs / video links. Students needing a different format (e.g., printed hardcopy) should make their own accommodations.

What You'll Need

- University-provided Gmail account
- Access to the learning management system (Lamaku)
- Reliable internet access outside class meeting times
- A laptop for in-class and take-home work

Alloy Research Schedule — What You'll Research Each Week

Wk	Topic	Alloys Researched	Wk	Topic	Alloys Researched
1	Atomic Structure	1018 steel (new)	10	Wrought Aluminum	6061-T6, 2024-T3 Al (new: 2024-T3)
2	Mech. Properties	1018, 1045 steel (new: 1045)	11	Aluminum Forming	6061-T6, 5086 Al (new: 5086)
3	NO CLASS	—	12	Machining Processes	1018, 1045 steel, 6061-T6 Al (revisit)
4	Carbon & Alloy Steels	1018, 1045, 1075 steel (new: 1075)	13	Copper Alloys	110, 182 Cu (new)
5	Stainless Steel	304, 316, 17-4PH SS (new)	14	Brass Alloys	260, 360, 464 brass (new: 464)
6	Nonferrous Metals	6061 Al, 260 brass (new)	15	Precip. Hardening	17-4PH SS, 2024-T3 Al, 182 Cu (revisit)
7	Mech. Testing	1018, 1045 steel (revisit)	16	Capstone & Synthesis	— (synthesis)
8	NDT Methods	1018 steel, 360 brass, Ti-6Al-4V (new: 360, Ti)			
9	Quality & Defects	1018 steel (revisit)			

Each week's research module draws from the shared 15-alloy specimen set. "Revisit" means an alloy you've already researched, now viewed through a new lens.

Coming Up — Week 1

Atomic Structure & Bonding

The atom, the periodic table, atomic bonding, alloys and solid solutions, crystal structures, and grain boundaries.

Questions? Reach out anytime.

Kainani “Kai” Santos · kainanis@hawaii.edu · CE401 · Office hours by appointment